



Inbound marketing

Inbound marketing lures customers by offering them appealing content, and engaging with them. The approach pulls customers into a relationship with a brand rather than “pushing” them into making a purchase, which is how advertising works. Inbound marketing is also known as permission marketing as potential customers are giving a business permission to communicate with them. In other words, they are actively interacting with the company or brand.

Inbound marketing process

Content forms the core of inbound marketing. It includes text, images, and video that consumers seek out online, especially on social media sites, or in person at events, such as trade fairs, and share with their network of friends, family, and colleagues. Potential customers respond to inbound marketing because the business or brand is offering interesting and relevant information, entertainment, or content with emotional value. Businesses expect this interaction to culminate in a sale, or create brand recognition that leads to a sale.



NEED TO KNOW

- › **Top of funnel marketing (TOFU)**
Offers content to grab the initial attention of potential customer
- › **Middle of funnel marketing MOFU** Offers more detail and encourages participation
- › **Bottom of funnel marketing (BOFU)** Attempts to win a sale with low pricing, offers, or via customer recommendations

Top types of content marketing

1. Blogs
2. How-to guides
3. Images
4. Infographics
5. Videos
6. Testimonials/reviews
7. Case studies
8. Internet memes
9. Email newsletters
10. E-books
11. Podcasts
12. Twitter chat
13. Newsjacking (giving content to news media)

Exploration

Publish and actively promote content; use search engine optimization (SEO) to attract consumers online

Decision-making

Ensure that content captivates potential customers or solves problems for them; encourage two-way communication

Purchase

Entice interested site visitors to become customers; make shopping online an easy and positive experience

Advocacy

Provide excellent customer service; spur customers to make recommendations and share on social media